

Product Review

OVERVIEW

Product name: Hyper Skin - Hyper Even Brightening Dark Spot Vitamin C Serum

Category: Skin care

Vehicle/form: Serum

Skin or hair type: All skin types

Used for: Reducing dark spots, hyperpigmentation, and uneven skin tone.

Black-owned business: Yes

Certified cruelty-free: No

Certified organic: No



KEY FINDINGS

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SAFETY

Moderate Risk

In certain situations, this product may cause irritation or an allergic reaction. Speak with your physician to learn more.

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RESEARCH / DATA AVAILABLE

Limited

There is limited published data on this product or ingredients used in the Black community.

RECOMMENDATION: Based on the data available, the product should be safe to use as per the instructions on the label. We strongly suggest testing with a limited amount of product on a small area and, if irritation occurs, discussing it with a licensed professional before continuing use.

SUPPORTING DATA AND ANALYSIS

Key Area	Findings
Active ingredients	3-O-ethyl ascorbic acid (vitamin C, 15%), kojic acid (1%), bearberry extract (contains arbutin), glycyrrhiza glabra (licorice) root extract
Inactive ingredients	Water (aqua), aloe barbadensis leaf juice, arctostaphylos uva ursi leaf extract, biotin, camellia oleifera (green tea) leaf extract, citric acid, corallina officinalis extract, curcuma longa (turmeric) root extract, ethylhexylglycerin, glycerin, hyaluronic acid, hydroxyethylcellulose, lactobacillus/papaya fruit ferment extract, lecithin, maltodextrin, melia azadirachta flower extract, melia azadirachta leaf extract, ocimum basilicum (basil) flower/leaf extract, ocimum sanctum leaf extract (holy basil), phenoxyethanol, phyllanthus emblica fruit extract, potassium sorbate, pullulan, pyrus malus (apple) fruit extract, saccharomyces/xylinum black tea ferment, salicylic acid, sclerotium gum, silica, sodium benzoate, sodium citrate, tetrasodium EDTA, tocopherol, xanthan

Formulation concerns	• Potential allergens and irritants: ◦ Kojic acid (1%) may cause contact dermatitis or sensitivity, especially in individuals with sensitive skin. ◦ Extended use may lead to skin irritation and, in some cases, paradoxical darkening if used without sun protection. ◦ Salicylic acid (<1%), though present in low concentrations, is a beta hydroxy acid (BHA) that can cause dryness, peeling, and irritation, especially for those with dry or sensitive skin. ◦ Not recommended for individuals allergic to aspirin due to its salicylate content. ◦ Turmeric extract is generally well tolerated but may cause contact dermatitis in sensitive individuals. ◦ Licorice root extract: Some users with sensitive skin may experience mild irritation or allergic reactions. • Photosensitivity risk: ◦ Kojic acid and salicylic acid can increase skin sensitivity to UV rays, making daily sunscreen application essential to avoid hyperpigmentation or irritation. ◦ Even though vitamin C (3-O-ethyl ascorbic acid) is an antioxidant, it can oxidize on the skin and cause irritation, particularly in sun-exposed areas if not followed by sunscreen. • Potential drying or over-exfoliation effects: ◦ The combination of kojic acid, salicylic acid, and vitamin C may be too strong for highly sensitive or compromised skin. ◦ Users with dry or eczema-prone skin may need to pair the serum with a hydrating moisturizer to minimize irritation, despite some moisturizers in the formulation. • Preservatives: ◦ Phenoxyethanol is a preservative and is considered safe at low concentrations but can cause mild irritation in some individuals, particularly those with highly reactive or allergy-prone skin. • Potential interactions with other skincare products: ◦ The combination of vitamin C, kojic acid, and salicylic acid with retinoids may lead to excessive dryness, peeling, and irritation. ◦ If using retinoids, consider alternating applications (e.g., vitamin C in the morning, retinoids at night). ◦ Caution with other exfoliating acids (AHAs/BHAs like glycolic acid, lactic acid, or mandelic acid) as combining this serum with other exfoliating acids could increase skin irritation, redness, and peeling. • The fruit enzymes provide mild exfoliation and may be a potential cause of skin irritation in those sensitive to these ingredients.
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Research and ingredient analysis	• Hyper Skin Hyper Even Brightening Dark Spot Vitamin C Serum contains a combination of active and inactive ingredients known to address hyperpigmentation effectively. • 3-O-ethyl ascorbic acid (vitamin C derivative) provides a skin-brightening effect. • Kojic acid, bearberry extract, and licorice root extract help lighten dark spots and brighten the skin. • The active ingredients are known for their effectiveness in treating hyperpigmentation, though they may cause irritation in sensitive individuals. • Other ingredients such as turmeric and camellia oleifera support anti-inflammatory effects. • Antioxidants such as ocimum basilicum and camellia oleifera also provide effective skin-calming effects. • Moisturizers including hyaluronic acid, aloe vera, glycerin, and lecithin help restore skin condition. • Salicylic acid and the fruit enzymes provide mild exfoliation and may be a potential cause of skin irritation in those sensitive to these ingredients.
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Data sources to consider	• FDA GRAS Notices: https://www.fda.gov/food/generally-recognized-safe-gras/gras-notice-inventory • EWG Skin Deep Database: https://www.ewg.org/skindeep/ • What's In My Jar (WIMJ): https://whatsinmyjar.com/ • SkinSafe Products: https://www.skinsafeproducts
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— See the legend on page 3 for a description of our scoring system. —

Last reviewed: February 2025

UNDERSTANDING YOUR RESULTS

WeSeeColor evaluates products by examining the ingredients listed on product labels and reviewing available scientific research and literature on both the products and their individual ingredients. Each product is rated on a 5-point scale, considering ingredient safety (and the potential for adverse reactions), the availability of data and research, and documented efficacy on Black skin and hair, when available.

SAFETY RATING

Very High Risk	High Risk	Moderate Risk	Low Risk	Very Low Risk
				
Caution. Strong likelihood that this product may cause irritation and/or an allergic reaction. Seek medical attention if exposed.	This product may cause irritation and/or an allergic reaction. Be careful and consult your physician.	In certain situations, this product may cause irritation or an allergic reaction. Speak with your physician to learn more.	Generally safe. Product ingredients have low irritancy or allergy potential.	Safe to use on most occasions. Product ingredients have negligible irritancy or allergy potential.

RESEARCH / DATA AVAILABILITY RATING

None	Limited	Fair	Good	Robust
				
There is no data on this product or ingredients used in the Black community.	There is limited published data on this product or ingredients used in the Black community.	There is a fair amount of published data or documented usage in the Black community.	Product or its ingredients have been studied extensively or used extensively in the Black community.	This product or its ingredients have been studied extensively, used extensively, and known in the Black community.

GENERAL CONSIDERATIONS

- Dietary supplements can have unexpected interactions with other products, drugs, or conditions. If the product is characterized as a dietary supplement, we recommend starting with a small intake and monitoring for potential side or adverse effects and consult with a licensed professional before resuming use.
- Allergens may sometimes be listed in labels using their scientific name (e.g. “arachis hypogaea oil” for “peanut oil”). Familiarize yourself with the scientific name of any ingredient to which you may be allergic and review the label carefully before starting usage.